Level 2 – divination
Casting time: **action** · Range: **Self** (30-foot radius) · Components: **V, S, M** (a copper piece) · Duration: **Concentration**, 1 minute

You sense the **presence of thoughts** within 30 ft: creatures that think, even hidden. You can focus on a creature **you can see** to read its **surface thoughts** (its immediate state of mind).

You can **probe deeper**: the target makes a **Wisdom save**; on a failure, you learn its reasoning, emotional state and what looms large in its mind. On a success, you can't probe it again for this casting and it **knows** you tried. A creature with Intelligence 3 or less, or that speaks no language, is unaffected.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Senses **thoughts** within 30 ft.
2. Reads a visible creature's **surface thoughts**.
3. **Probe**: the target's Wisdom save.
4. Blocked by **2 ft of stone**, **2 in. of metal**, lead or **3 ft of wood/dirt**.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps the effect and clarifies the target knows it's being probed if it succeeds its save.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The spell doesn't say how to describe received thoughts. Fix: the DM summarizes in a sentence or two, revealing no more than needed.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe thoughts as whispers or blurry images.

Step 1 – Cast:

Action; material component: a copper piece. You sense thoughts within 30 ft.

Step 2 – Detect:

You know where thinking creatures are, even behind a thin obstacle.

Step 3 – Read the surface:

Focus on a visible creature: you read its surface thoughts.

Step 4 – Probe:

The target makes a Wisdom save; failure: you learn more; success: it knows you probe.

Step 5 – Obstacles:

2 ft of stone, 2 in. of common metal, a thin sheet of lead or 3 ft of wood or dirt block the spell.

Example: Elora reads a merchant's surface thoughts: he's thinking about money. She probes (failed Wisdom save): he fears a guard inspection.

⚠ Common questions:

Must I see the target?

To read the surface or probe: yes.

What's read at the surface?

Immediate state of mind and what the creature is thinking of.

Can I read a creature with no Int?

No: Int 3 or less, or no language, is unaffected.

Is the target warned?

Only if it succeeds the save when probed.

Which obstacles?

Stone 2 ft, metal 2 in., lead, 3 ft of wood or dirt.

Concentration?

Yes: damage ⇒ Constitution save.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Deep thoughts

How far does probing go? **Option**: one key fact.

Lies

Can thoughts be false? **Option**: no, the reading is reliable.

Foreign thoughts

Understanding an unknown language. **Option**: impressions only.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Surface thoughts

That's the immediate state of mind, not all memory.

Probing

A success prevents further probing and warns the target.

Obstacles

Thick barriers block the sensing.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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